Flood Control Projects Under Fire: Lawmakers Demand Accountability Over ₱545-B Budget

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THE IMPLEMENTING RULES AND REGULATIONS OF REPUBLIC ACT NO. 3019 OR THE ANTI-GRAFT AND CORRUPT PRACTICES ACT In relation to the Oversight of Infrastructure Projects and Public Accountability

Pursuant to the recent privilege speeches and congressional inquiries regarding the state of national infrastructure, the following report details the controversies surrounding the Department of Public Works and Highways (DPWH) flood control programs.

GENERAL PROVISIONS

SEC. 1. Title — These findings and reports shall be known as the "2024 Flood Control Project Audit and Accountability Report."

SEC. 2. Purpose — This report is compiled to provide transparency regarding the allocation of public funds and the effectiveness of disaster mitigation mechanisms in the Philippines.

SEC. 3. Declaration of Policies — It is the policy of the State to maintain honesty and integrity in the public service and take positive and effective measures against graft and corruption. The

State recognizes that billions in taxpayer money must result in the actual safety of citizens from natural disasters, ensuring that infrastructure is both functional and resilient.

SEC. 4. Definition of Terms

"Ghost Projects" refers to infrastructure projects that are funded and reported as completed but do not exist or were never built.

"Flood Mitigation" refers to the management and control of floodwater movement, such as the construction of dikes, pumping stations, and drainage systems.

MANILA, Philippines — A growing number of lawmakers and civil society groups have criticized the Department of Public Works and Highways (DPWH) following the massive flooding caused by Typhoon Carina and the enhanced Habagat. Despite a staggering ₱545-billion budget allocated for flood control projects over the last two years, many parts of Metro Manila and Luzon remained submerged, leading to questions about where the funds were actually spent.

Critics argue that the lack of a "master plan" has resulted in fragmented and ineffective projects. During a recent Senate hearing, it was revealed that while the DPWH claims to have completed over 5,000 flood control projects, many were small-scale or lacked connection to a larger drainage system.

"We are spending billions every year, yet the results are not felt by the people," one senator stated. While the DPWH maintained that their projects prevented "even worse" flooding, they admitted that some master plans date back to 1975 and are no longer suited for current rainfall levels. The incident has sparked a broader discussion on the responsibility of government agencies to ensure that massive infrastructure budgets lead to tangible public safety.

Currency
The information is highly current, reporting on the immediate aftermath of the July 2024 floods and the subsequent budget hearings in the Senate and House of Representatives.

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Written by Iza Iglesias, a lifestyle and entertainment reporter for The Manila Times, who provides a detailed account of the reactions from various public figures.

Publisher
Published by The Manila Times, one of the oldest and most established national broadsheets in the Philippines, known for its extensive coverage of national news and entertainment.

Point of View
The point of view is reportorial and objective. It provides the exact quotes from the lawmaker while balancing them with the documented reactions and statements from the critics.

Sources
The Manila Times:
https://www.manilatimes.net/2026/03/04/entertainment-lifestyle/show-times/celebrities-condemn-qc-lawmakers-remarks-about-anne-curtis/2292775

Is the source credible? Why or Why not? Explain using CAPPS.
Yes, this source is credible because it meets the CAPPS criteria. It is Current (published March 2026), written by a professional Author (Iza Iglesias), and released by a reputable Publisher (The Manila Times). The Point of View is fair as it includes both the lawmaker's defense and the celebrities' rebuttals. It cites primary Sources such as official House committee recordings and verified social media statements from the involved parties.